

THE MODERN SMALL BUSINESS PROSPECTING PLAYBOOK

Thanks for checking out The Modern Small Business Prospecting Playbook!

I created this resource to simplify what most people overcomplicate, finding and connecting with real prospects in a consistent, authentic way. This isn't theory or marketing fluff; it's the exact system I use daily to start conversations, build relationships, and turn activity into results.

Whether you're in sales, business development, or running your own company, this playbook will help you:

- Build structure into your outreach routine
- Use modern tools to work smarter, not harder
- Show up every day with value, confidence, and purpose

Keep it simple. Stay consistent. And remember, it's not about the volume of outreach; it's about the quality of the relationships you create.

Welcome to a better way to prospect.

THE PROSPECTING MINDSET

Cold prospecting isn't about blasting out thousands of messages, it's about building real relationships through consistency and value.

Every interaction should educate, help, or connect. Your focus: show up every day with something useful and genuine. Over time, familiarity builds trust, and trust creates opportunities.

MY TECH STACK

Seamless.ai – Lead Sourcing

- I use Seamless.ai to find verified small business contact data.
- Filters: company size (5–75 employees), geography, and industry.
- I export 1,000 new leads daily to feed into my sequences

ZeroBounce – Email Verification

- Every list runs through ZeroBounce before use.
- It removes invalid, duplicate, and spam-risk emails to protect my domain and boost deliverability.

Wix – One-Off Email Campaigns

- I use Wix for one-off educational emails or updates.
- Topics include common industry mistakes, strategy tips, and new insights.
- Every email drives readers to my main profile, website, or consultation page.

Reply.io – Automated Sequences

- I add 1,000 new verified contacts daily to pre-built, automated Reply.io sequences.
- My sequences are short, conversational, and value-first — not pushy.
- Example flow:

Day 1: Intro

Day 3: Client story or insight

Day 6: Quick tip or industry stat

Day 10: Final friendly follow-up

Reply.io tracks engagement so I can focus on warm replies and active prospects.

TECH STACK PAGE 2

Alignable – Local Business Networking

- Alignable is where I engage directly with small business owners and professionals.
- I join community groups, ask questions, and share insights that attract attention.
- Before messaging, I engage with a business's posts or profile — liking, commenting, or responding to discussions.
- Then I send 50 personalized messages daily, focused on value and education.

LinkedIn – Authority & Visibility

- I post educational content to attract small business owners and potential partners.
- I comment on 30–40 posts daily to increase visibility and build familiarity.
- I send 8–10 personalized LinkedIn messages daily, usually after engaging with their posts first.
- This warm approach makes outreach more natural and boosts response rates.
- I use LinkedIn to drive traffic to my website, content, or referral network.

Nextlink – LinkedIn Optimization & Automation

- I use Nextlink to automate connection requests, follow-ups, and engagement.
- It keeps my outreach consistent while still allowing for personalization.

TECH STACK PAGE 2

Facebook – Competitive Research & Community Prospecting

- Like and follow your top competitors' Facebook pages so their ads appear in your feed — this helps you monitor how they position themselves and engage with clients.
- Check their comment sections for questions, feedback, or unhappy customers. When appropriate, reach out professionally by message, email, or phone with something genuinely helpful.
- Join local small business and industry-specific Facebook groups where your target audience spends time.
- Engage naturally — comment on discussions, answer questions, and post helpful insights or free resources.
- When group members engage with your posts or mention challenges, start a private conversation focused on value.

Craigslist – Hiring & Active Business Signals

- Craigslist is one of the most underrated lead sources for finding active local businesses.
- Check the “Jobs” section in your target area — companies posting help-wanted ads are hiring, growing, and likely need better systems, tools, or services.
- Look for posts from small businesses that match your ideal customer profile.
- Visit their website or LinkedIn page to learn more about them, then reach out directly via email or phone.

Example outreach:

“Hi [Name], I saw your company is hiring on Craigslist — congrats on the growth. I work with small businesses that are expanding and often looking to [solve X problem]. Thought I'd reach out to share a few quick ideas that might help streamline things as you scale.”

- This approach works best because you're reaching out at the right time — when they're active, hiring, and making decisions.

DAILY PROSPECTING ROUTINE

MORNING (60 MINUTES)

- PULL 1,000 NEW CONTACTS FROM SEAMLESS.AI
- VERIFY WITH ZEROBOUNCE
- IMPORT VERIFIED CONTACTS INTO REPLY.IO SEQUENCES

MIDDAY (60 MINUTES)

- ENGAGE WITH POSTS FROM TARGET PROSPECTS OR PARTNERS BEFORE MESSAGING
- COMMENT ON 30–40 LINKEDIN POSTS
- SEND 8–10 LINKEDIN MESSAGES (AFTER ENGAGING FIRST)
- POST ONE SHORT, VALUABLE LINKEDIN UPDATE

AFTERNOON (60 MINUTES)

- ENGAGE WITH POSTS AND DISCUSSIONS ON ALIGNABLE BEFORE OUTREACH
- SEND 50 ALIGNABLE MESSAGES OFFERING VALUE OR A FREE RESOURCE
- SPEND 20 MINUTES IN FACEBOOK GROUPS — LIKE COMPETITOR PAGES, JOIN NEW COMMUNITIES, AND COMMENT ON POSTS
- CHECK CRAIGSLIST JOB POSTINGS FOR ACTIVE BUSINESSES AND REACH OUT TO OWNERS OR HIRING CONTACTS
- RESPOND TO LINKEDIN, FACEBOOK, AND EMAIL REPLIES
- SEND A ONE-OFF WIX CAMPAIGN IF PROMOTING NEW CONTENT OR OFFERS

WEEKLY TASKS:

- REVIEW REPLY.IO PERFORMANCE (OPEN/REPLY RATES, MEETINGS BOOKED)
- ADD NEW WARM CONTACTS TO CRM OR NURTURE LIST
- REFRESH SEAMLESS.AI SEARCHES AND UPDATE TARGETING
- IDENTIFY 3–5 NEW FACEBOOK GROUPS TO JOIN OR MONITOR
- REVIEW CRAIGSLIST POSTINGS TO SPOT HIRING TRENDS IN YOUR REGION

MESSAGING STRATEGY

Alignable Message Example:

Hi [Name], I saw your post in [group/topic]. I help small business owners and professionals simplify [problem you solve] so they can focus on growth.

I'd love to send you a free checklist that helps uncover hidden [pain point] — want me to send it?

LinkedIn Message Example (Referral Partner):

Hi [Name], I liked your post about [topic] — great point on [specific insight].

I partner with [type of professionals] to help their clients improve [outcome].

Would love to connect and explore ways to collaborate.

Facebook Message Example:

Hi [Name], I saw your comment in [group name] — great discussion on [topic].

I work with small business owners on similar challenges and thought I'd reach out to share a few quick ideas that might help.

Craigslist Outreach Example:

Hi [Name], I came across your job posting on Craigslist — looks like your business is growing, congrats!

I work with local companies during growth phases to help them [achieve X outcome].

Would you be open to a quick chat or resource I can send over?

TRACKING AND OPTIMIZATION

- Track daily outreach, comments, and messages across all platforms.
- Measure engagement (views, comments, and profile visits).
- A/B test message openers and subject lines every few weeks.
- Use a CRM or Google Sheet to log prospects and referral partner conversations.

SCALING THE SYSTEM

Once your routine runs smoothly:

- Expand Seamless.ai searches into new industries (restaurants, trades, retail, healthcare, etc.).
- Create a Wix landing page for your “Efficiency Checklist” or free guide.
- Retarget post viewers with LinkedIn or Meta ads.
- Partner with complementary professionals for joint events or shared resources.

BONUS: HOW TO STAND OUT

- BE VISIBLY HELPFUL ONLINE YOUR COMMENTS AND POSTS ARE MICRO FIRST IMPRESSIONS.
 - SHARE RESULTS AND INSIGHTS, NOT PITCHES.
- PERSONALIZE 10% OF YOUR AUTOMATION FOR 90% OF YOUR ENGAGEMENT LIFT.
 - KEEP SHOWING UP!! CONSISTENCY BEATS CREATIVITY IN SALES PROSPECTING.

THANK YOU

THANKS FOR READING!

I BUILT THIS PLAYBOOK TO HELP OTHER SALES PROFESSIONALS FILL
THEIR PIPELINES WITH GENUINE, QUALIFIED CONVERSATIONS – NOT
COLD SPAM.

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